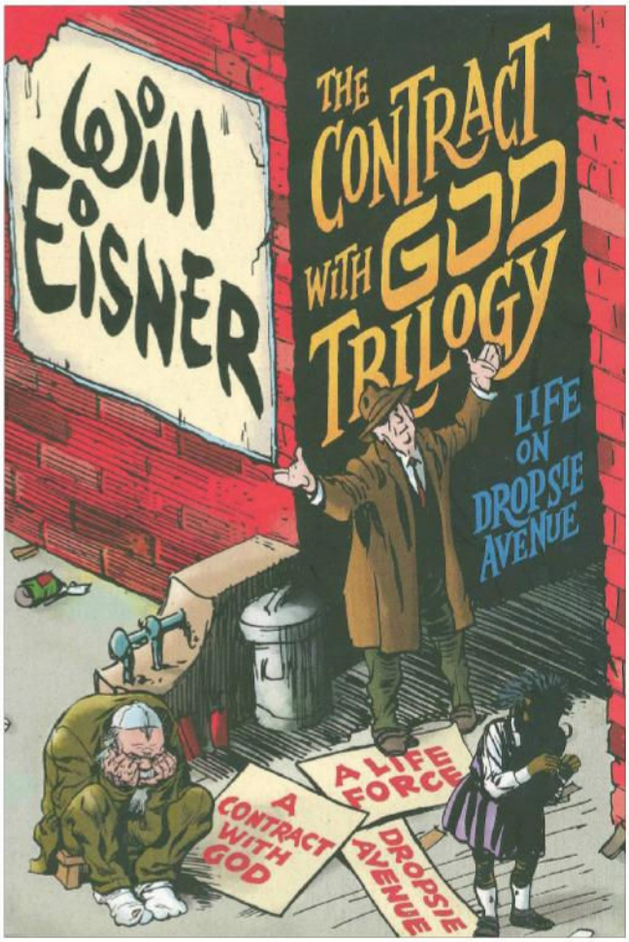
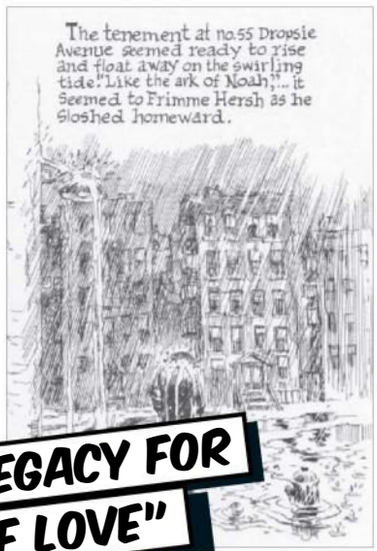


A CONTRACT WITH GOD

Details **Originally published** A Contract With God And Other Tenement Stories (1978-95) **Publisher** Baronet Books **Writer** Will Eisner **Artist** Will Eisner **Collected in** N/A **Available digitally** Kindle

His Golden Age credentials undisputed, Will Eisner – creator of *The Spirit* – kickstarted a new, more introspective and deeply personal age of comics with the first in his three-volume *A Contract With God* series – arguably the first modern graphic novel. As deft a cartoonist as he was a writer, Eisner peered behind the crisp suit jackets, off-the-shoulder gowns and big band jazz of *The Spirit*'s stylised New York City to reveal the crumbling tenement's of his own childhood, exploring the lives of Jewish immigrants in the Bronx of the Thirties through a series of semi-autobiographical shorts.



A Contract With God stands the other side of the curtains from the great literary portraits of the era, forever on the outside looking in thanks to a cartoonish brand of clunky melodrama and exaggerated reality. A fitting legacy indeed for a tale of love, life and loss on the wrong side of the tracks.

"A FITTING LEGACY FOR A TALE OF LOVE"

SCALPED: THE GRAVEL IN YOUR GUTS

Details **Originally published** Scalped #21-24 (2009) **Publisher** DC/Vertigo **Writer** Jason Aaron **Artist** Davide Furno, RM Guera **Collected in** Scalped: Vol 4 - The Gravel in Your Guts **Available digitally** Comixology

Scalped: The Gravel in Your Guts is a searingly perceptive treatment of what it means to sell out as an ethnic minority in contemporary America. It's no longer a choice between doing the right thing and assimilating, but rather between doing the right thing and preventing one's people from dying.

Lincoln Red Crow, chief of the Prairie Rose reservation, is charged with purifying the soul of his dead ex-lover. To that end, he must lead a non-violent life – which means allowing a gang enforcer to torture and murder Prairie Rose residents without retribution.



The task leads him to try and reconcile the ghosts of his idealistic, activist past with his crime-filled present, knowing that any choice will come at great personal cost to himself or to those in his care. It's a gut-wrenching exploration of a broken social system that leaves no room for principles: only survival and damnation.

